

EVENT FORMAT

This is a multi-stage event designed to test the entrepreneurial mindset, adaptability, negotiation skills, and presentation capabilities of the participants. The event is split into two distinct days: Day 1 focuses on ideation, strategy, and adaptation; Day 2 transitions into a Innovation Carnival environment focusing on networking, validation, and crowd sourced investment.

Team Size: 2-5 members per team

DAY 1

Round 1: The Investigation (Elimination Round)

Round 1 consists of three phases in which all teams participate simultaneously. Clues are released through three different mediums video, audio, and social media. After each clue, teams answer five mentimeter questions, with scoring based on accuracy and response time.

- **Phase I – Video Clue**

A clue is presented to all teams through a video screened at the venue. Following the screening, participants answer five mentimeter questions simultaneously. Scoring is based on both accuracy and response speed. Live leaderboard updates are displayed after each question, allowing teams to track their performance in real time.

- **Phase II – Audio Clue**

The second clue is delivered through an audio format such as a podcast clip, analyst call, or customer voicemail. At the end of this phase, scores from both Phase I and Phase II are combined to generate an updated cumulative leaderboard.

- **Phase III – Social Media Clue**

The final clue is released through a dedicated fictional brand account activated during the event. Teams analyze the account's posts and stories before answering the final set of five mentimeter questions. Upon completion, the final cumulative leaderboard is revealed, following which the highest-ranking teams advance to Round 2 while the remaining teams are eliminated.

Round 2: Startup Simulation

Following the elimination round, the qualified teams proceed to a live card allocation session. Each team draws one card from each of the three categories **User Card**, **Problem Card**, and **Technology Card**.

The resulting combination defines the team's opportunity space for Round 2 and serves as the foundation for their startup concept and MVP. The combinations are intentionally randomized to encourage unconventional thinking and push participants beyond obvious solutions

• Phase I – Card Allocation

Each team is randomly choose three cards displayed on the website:

- User Card – Identifies the target audience.
- Problem Card – Defines the challenge to be addressed.
- Technology Card – Specifies the technological domain to be utilized.

• Phase II – Trading & Negotiation

Following the card allocation stage, teams are provided with a dedicated negotiation window during which they may interact with other participants and mutually exchange cards. This trading phase allows teams to strategically refine, optimize, or pivot their ideas

• Phase III – Crisis Intervention

To simulate real world uncertainties faced by startups, each team receives a **Crisis Card** containing an unexpected challenge or constraint that requires them to modify their solution. These scenarios may include budget reductions, changes in target audience, technology restrictions, increased competition, or regulatory limitations. Teams must adapt their concepts accordingly.

• Phase IV – MVP Submission

Following the completion of all previous stages, teams refine their concepts by incorporating insights gained through card allocation, negotiations, and crisis interventions. The final MVP will be submitted within the prescribed timeline.

Upon completion of the MVP submission stage, all entries will be reviewed. Selected teams will proceed to Day 2, where they will showcase their solutions at the Innovation Carnival.

DAY 2

The Innovation Carnival

Day 2 adopts an exhibition based format inspired by startup expos and innovation fairs.

Each team is allotted a dedicated display space to showcase its idea, prototype, wireframe, or proof of concept. Rather than conventional stage presentations, teams interact directly with visitors and communicate their value propositions through demonstrations and discussions.

Judgment Criteria

Rather than following the traditional format of stage presentations and formal judging panels, this event adopts a more interactive approach. Participating teams engage directly with visitors in an exhibition-style environment, allowing ideas to be experienced through conversations, demonstrations, and live interactions.

Visitors may include eliminated teams, friends and peers of participating teams, members of societies, fics etc . As they explore ,the visitors are encouraged to interact, understand and support promising ideas through the Investment Coin mechanism

Investment Coin Mechanism

Visitors are provided with themed Investment Coins, each corresponding to a specific evaluation criterion. These coins symbolize support and act as the primary mechanism for determining winners.

Indicative Categories:

- Best UI/UX
- Best Innovation
- Market Viability
- Social Impact

(More can be decided later)

To create a more balanced and biasfree evaluation process, all visitors must distribute their investments across multiple teams to ensure equitable participation and secondly the events incorporates a weighted Investment Coin system. For instance, coins allocated to faculty members carry a higher weight than those assigned to general visitors

Awards and Conclusion

Winning teams are determined based on the volume and category wise distribution of Investment Coins accumulated during the carnival.

Awards may include:

- Best Innovation
- Best UI/UX
- Market Viability Award
- Social Impact Award
- People's Choice Award